MICHAEL LAFOREST-TUCKER
Curriculum Vitae

michael.tucker@gwu.edu michaellaforest.github.io

CURRENT APPOINTMENT

Amsterdam Assistant Professor of Public Policy, George Washington University 2025 – Present

AFFILIATIONS

Affiliate, Crime & Education Lab, University of Chicago 2020 – Present
Affiliate, Criminal Justice Research Center, Pennsylvania State University 2023 – Present
Affiliate, Office of Labor and Economic Analysis, United States Air Force Academy 2025 – Present

PRIOR EXPERIENCE

Assistant Professor of Economics, United States Air Force Academy 2023 – 2025
Postdoctoral Scholar, Criminal Justice Research Center, Pennsylvania State University 2020 – 2023
Research Director, Crime and Education Lab New York, University of Chicago 2017 – 2020
Strategy and Change Consultant, IBM Global Business Services 2007 – 2010

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, University of Virginia 2017
B.S. Economics & Political Science, Mathematics minor, University of Michigan 2007

FIELDS

Public Economics, Labor Economics, Economics of Crime

PUBLICATIONS

Can Crime be Deterred at Low Cost? Evidence from a Randomized Experiment in New York (with Oludamilare Aboaba, Aaron Chalfin, Lucie Parker, and Patrick Sharkey). 2026. ***Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*** 45(2): e70092.

(A Structural Model of) The Effects of High School Career and Technical Education on Employment, Wages, and Educational Attainment. 2023. ***Journal of Human Capital*** 17(1): 39-71.

Knowledge About Others Reduces One's Own Sense of Anonymity (with Anuj Shah). 2022. ***Nature*** 603: 297–301.

Street Light Outages, Public Safety and Crime Attraction (with Aaron Chalfin and Jacob Kaplan). 2022. ***Journal of Quantitative Criminology*** 38: 891–919. *(top five journal in Criminology)*

Can Precision Policing Reduce Gun Violence? Evidence from "Gang Takedowns" in New York City (with Aaron Chalfin and Jacob Kaplan). 2021. ***Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*** 40(4): 1047-1082.

WORKING PAPERS

Can Technology Facilitate Scale? Evidence from a Randomized Evaluation of High Dosage Tutoring (with Monica Bhatt, Jonathan Guryan, and Salman Khan). NBER Working Paper 32510 (Revise and Resubmit, *Journal of Human Resources*).

Parole Supervision on the Margins (Under Review, *American Economic Review*).

Parole Officer Effects on Reentry: Support, Deterrence, and Bias (Under Review, *Journal of Political Economy*).

One Size Doesn't Fit All – The Heterogeneous Effects of Prison Programs (available upon request).

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

When to Retire? The Effects of a Transition from Pensions to a Blended Retirement System in the U.S. Military (with Zachary Fone and Nathan Wozny).

Within-Officer Bias in Arrest and Use of Force Decisions – Evidence from Dallas (with Adam Soliman).

The Effects of Monetary Retention Bonuses on Career Decisions: Experimental Evidence from the U.S. Air Force (with Francis X. Murphy and Nathan Wozny).

The Waiting is the Hardest Part – The Effects of Exogenous Wait Times to Begin a Career (with Adam Bestenbostel, Kristopher Demming, and Ian MacDonald).

GRANTS & AWARDS

Arnold Ventures Open Access Funding ($4,090) 2026
for "Street Light Outages, Public Safety and Crime Attraction" (with Aaron Chalfin and Jacob Kaplan)

Arnold Ventures Research Grant ($97,302) 2025 – Present
for "The Heterogeneous Effects of Prison Programs"

Arnold Ventures Research Grant ($115,474) 2024 – Present
for "Parole Supervision on the Margins"

Arnold Ventures Event Funding ($40,000) 2024
for Innovation Day Conference with the Pennsylvania Department of Corrections. Co-organizer (with Kristofer B. Bucklen, Amber Petkus, and Gary Zajac)

Cialdini Prize for Field Research, Society for Personality and Social Psychology ($1,000) 2024
for "Knowledge about Others Reduces One's Own Sense of Anonymity" (with Anuj Shah)

Laura and John Arnold Foundation Research Grant ($350,505) 2018 – 2025

for "Using Technology to Reduce the Cost of High Dosage Tutoring: Experimental Evidence." Co-Principal Investigator (with Monica Bhatt and Jonathan Guryan)

Overdeck Family Foundation Research Grant ($122,000) 2018 – 2025
for "Using Technology to Reduce the Cost of High Dosage Tutoring: Experimental Evidence." Co-Principal Investigator (with Monica Bhatt and Jonathan Guryan)

Southern Economic Association Graduate Student Award ($200) 2016

Bankard Pre-Doctoral Fellowship ($15,000) 2014 – 2015

Radulovacki Summer Research Fellowship ($1,000) 2013

UVA Quantitative Collaborate Fellowship ($2,000) 2012 – 2013

TEACHING

Instructor, George Washington University
Econometrics for Policy Research II F2026

Instructor, United States Air Force Academy
Public-Sector Economics F2023, F2024
100% "Excellent" instructor rating (F2023)

Instructor, University of Virginia S2014
Economics of the Public Sector

Teaching Assistant, University of Virginia 2011-2016
Graduate Microeconomic Theory II, Graduate Microeconomic Theory I, Game Theory, Principles of Microeconomics, Principles of Macroeconomics

PEER REVIEWER

Quarterly Journal of Economics; Review of Economics and Statistics; Journal of Human Resources; Journal of Public Economics; Journal of Human Capital; Journal of Policy Analysis and Management; Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization; Journal of Comparative Economics; Oxford Economic Papers; European Economic Review; International Review of Law & Economics; Journal of Experimental Criminology; American Law & Economics Review; Law & Policy; Educational Researcher; Criminal Justice Review; Journal of Empirical Legal Studies; Journal of Research in Crime and Delinquency; Crime Prevention and Community Safety; International Journal of Drug Policy

INVITED TALKS & CONVENINGS

2026 Association of Public Policy Analysis and Management, Virtual Crime Economics (ViCE) Seminar

2025 Arnold Ventures BRIDGE events (Community Service as Non-Fine Punishment, Improving the Parole Process, Medical and Geriatric Parole, Women in the Criminal Justice System), EXiT Network convening on Community Supervision Research, George Washington University, Southern Economic Association, Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime, University of Copenhagen (Center for Economic Behavior and Inequality), University of Florida, University of Virginia, West Point Social Science Seminar

2024 Association of Public Policy Analysis and Management, Center for Economic Performance Policing and Crime Workshop, Fostering Public Safety Workshop, Niskanen Center Criminal Justice Convening, Pennsylvania Corrections Innovation Day, Southern Economic Association

2023 Association of Public Policy Analysis and Management, Lund University, Malmö University, Southern Economic Association, Transatlantic Workshop on the Economics of Crime, United States Air Force Academy, University of Alabama, Western Economic Association International, Workshop on the Economics of Crime for Junior Scholars

2022 American Economic Association, Association of Public Policy Analysis and Management, Copenhagen Business School, ROCKWOOL Foundation, Southern Economic Association, University of Copenhagen (Center for Economic Behavior and Inequality), University of Southern Denmark

2021 American Society of Criminology, Association of Public Policy Analysis and Management, Copenhagen Business School, Niskanen Center (Webinar on Reducing Violence), Virtual Crime Economics (ViCE) Seminar – Fall, Virtual Crime Economics (ViCE) Seminar – Spring, Penn State University, Southern Economic Association

2020 American Society of Criminology, Association of Public Policy Analysis and Management, Mississippi State University, Office of Evaluation Sciences, Penn State University (Criminal Justice Research Center), Southern Economic Association, Tulane University (Education Research Alliance for New Orleans)

2017 Bureau of Economic Analysis, Federal Trade Commission, Office of the Comptroller of the Currency, University of Chicago (Crime and Education Lab New York)

2016 Association for Education Finance and Policy, Bureau of Labor Statistics, Southern Economic Association, University of Virginia

REPORTS

The Parole Process – Summary of the Causal Research Landscape (with Ryan Sakoda). 2025. Arnold Ventures Bridge Day Policy Brief, commissioned by Arnold Ventures (*available upon request).*

Community Supervision and Public Safety: What We Know and Directions for Future Work (with Jennifer Doleac). 2022. Arnold Ventures Public Safety Series Report, commissioned by Arnold Ventures.

Comparing COVID-19 Mortality Rates between Prisons and the Community (with Kristofer B. Bucklen), 2022. *Corrections: Policy, Practice and Research*. https://doi.org/10.1080/23774657.2022.2110174.

The Estimated Effect of the Youth Reentry Network on Criminal Justice Outcomes (with Oludamilare Aboaba and Jason Learner). 2019. Crime Lab New York Policy Brief, prepared for the New York City Mayor's Office of Criminal Justice, the New York City Department of Correction, and the Friends of Island Academy *(available upon request).*

Analysis of the "Friday Night Lights" Evening Youth Basketball Initiative (with Zach Honoroff, Natalee Rivera, and Anna Solow-Collins). 2018. Crime Lab New York Policy Brief, prepared for the New York County District Attorney's Office *(available upon request).*

Variation in Mental Illness and Provision of Public Services (with William C. Johnson, Brett Lissenden, and Steven Stern). 2017. *Health Services and Outcomes Research Methodology* 17: 1-30.

SERVICE

Professional Service

Review Committee, APPAM 2025 Crime & Justice Sessions 2025
Mentor, APPAM Mentor Matching Program 2025 – Present
Mentor, Association for Mentoring & Inclusion in Economics 2023 – Present
Co-organizer, Innovation Day Conference with the PA Department of Corrections 2024

Institutional Service, United States Air Force Academy

Undergraduate Advisor, Veritatis Kong (*Senior Capstone Project*) 2024 – 2025
Faculty Advisor, Cadet Board Game Club 2024 – 2025
Committee Member, OLEA Project Development Committee 2024 – 2025
Committee Member, OLEA Outreach Committee 2023 – 2025

Institutional Service, University of Virginia

Founder and Officer, UVA Economics Graduate Club 2011 – 2016
Vice President of Operations, UVA Graduate Student Council 2013 – 2016

Institutional Service, University of Michigan

External Relations Committee Member, Michigan Student Assembly 2003 – 2007
Director, Disarmament & International Security Committee, Model UN Conference 2003 – 2007
Executive Board, College Democrats 2003 – 2007
Board Member and Actor, Residential College Players 2003 – 2007

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Temporary Appointments

Visiting Researcher, University of Copenhagen 2025 – 2026
Visiting Researcher, Copenhagen Business School 2022 – 2023
Research Assistant for Dr. Benjamin Castleman, University of Virginia 2016 – 2017

Internships, University of Michigan

Intern, FTI Consulting, Washington, DC 2006
Intern, United States House of Representatives (*Fred Upton - R, MI*), Washington, DC 2005
Branch Operator, College Works Painting, Ann Arbor, MI 2004

Language Proficiency

English *(Native)*, Danish *(Basic - A1)*

Computing Proficiency

Stata, Matlab, R, Fortran 95, Microsoft Office

Personal Interests

Travel, college sports, board games, movies, hiking, theater